Austria: energy security, economic opportunity and partnership priorities

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AI-generated from the data and checked against it; paper baseline as of 12 October 2026.

Summary

- Austria is most exposed in upstream coal and midstream batteries, where its Energy Security is higher than only 6% and 9% of the other economies scored. In coal, production minus consumption was -0.0957 EJ in 2025.[1,2,3]
- Its strongest openings are in midstream oil and midstream gas, where its Economic Opportunity is higher than 99% and 96% of the other economies scored.[1]
- On the paper's weighting, the Strategic Index ranks upstream nuclear 1st among Austria's own sectors, almost tied with upstream batteries. Top data-based priority meets the most policy activity in upstream batteries, upstream solar, midstream batteries and midstream solar.[1]
- The Partnership Strength Index rates Germany highest for Austria, as an export market. It is also Austria's 1st trade partner; China ranks 3rd by trade but 43rd on Partnership Strength.[1,4]

1. Energy security risks and why

11 of Austria's 30 placed sectors, those whose scores can be compared with other economies, sit in the two low-energy-security corners. Energy Security measures how well a country can rely on what it needs in a sector: its own production and reserves, its import needs and how concentrated world supply is.[1]

Its lowest Energy Security percentiles are in upstream coal, midstream batteries and upstream nuclear. In upstream coal it scores 0.25, higher than only 6% of the other 95 economies scored. In midstream batteries it scores 0.29, higher than 9% of the other 53, and in upstream nuclear 0.16, higher than 12% of the other 174. All sit in the Upgrade corner, where opportunity is high but energy security low.[1]

Its high-priority sectors are the high-opportunity, low-energy-security sectors that the Strategic Index ranks highest. They include upstream nuclear and midstream batteries. In upstream nuclear, trade pulls the score down: its share of world exports of these goods was 0.0% in 2023, and on this measure it scores higher than only 7% of the other economies. In midstream batteries, investment and trade pull it down. Its investment score is 0.00 against a median of 0.25: most of its measures are not reported by the source, which the index counts as zero. Its trade deficit in these goods equalled 0.2% of GDP in 2023.[1,5]

In upstream coal the score is low mainly because of import needs and trade. Coal production minus consumption was -0.0957 EJ in 2025 (production from the U.S. Energy Information Administration's international statistics, as the Energy Institute does not report it separately). Its trade deficit in these goods equalled 0.2% of GDP in 2023.[2,3,5]

For context, Austria imported USD 1.6 bn of midstream battery goods in 2024; its largest suppliers were China (33.9%), Poland (13.9%) and Germany (11.8%).[4]

2. Economic opportunities and why

28 of its 30 placed sectors sit in the two high-opportunity corners. Economic Opportunity measures how well placed a country is to create value in a sector: exports, related capabilities, investment, costs, demand and technology readiness.[1]

Its highest Economic Opportunity percentiles are in midstream oil, midstream gas and downstream solar, higher than 99%, 96% and 96% of the other economies scored in each. All sit in the Grow corner.[1]

In midstream oil, trade and cost competitiveness push the score up. Its exports of these goods were USD 1.91 bn in 2024. Its revealed comparative advantage, its share of world exports of these goods relative to its share of all world exports, was 1.54 in 2024. In midstream gas the same categories push it up: its export feasibility, how close these goods are to what it already exports well, is 0.41 for 2023, higher than 95% of the other economies. In downstream solar, cost competitiveness and energy access push it up: its consumption in this sector was 4.13 GJ per person in 2025.[1,2,5,6]

For context, its largest markets for midstream oil in 2024 were the United States (27.4%) and Germany (14.4%).[4]

The paper's framework associates the Grow corner, high opportunity with high energy security, with building on strength (export promotion in RMI (2025)). 9 of Austria's sectors sit in the Upgrade corner, which pairs high opportunity with low energy security; the framework associates it with building domestic capability (leapfrogging).[1]

3. Sectoral priorities and the existing policy posture

The Strategic Index ranks a country's own sectors by how strongly the data point to prioritising them, adding opportunity, security need, existing policy activity, the stage and the technology's low-emission value. On the paper's weighting, it ranks upstream nuclear 1st among Austria's own sectors at 0.66, almost tied with upstream batteries (0.000 apart). Security need adds 0.251 to that score and opportunity 0.157.[1]

It ranks upstream batteries 2nd, upstream solar 3rd and downstream solar 4th; each is almost tied with the sector ranked after it, at 0.006, 0.002 and 0.008 apart. Austria's allied pick, its first upstream or midstream sector on the Strategic Index after a resource-base screen, is midstream batteries, ranked 5th. The upstream sectors ranked above it are screened out because no resource base is recorded for them.[1,7]

To compare priorities with policy without counting policy in both, priority is read without the policy term, and both are split into thirds of Austria's sectors. Top priority meets the most policy activity in upstream batteries, upstream solar, midstream batteries and midstream solar, and no top-priority sector falls among those with the least policy. The reverse, bottom priority with the most policy, applies to downstream green hydrogen.[1]

Austria carries the European Union's Climate Action Tracker rating, Insufficient as of November 2024. Austria has 240 International Energy Agency Policies and Measures records, of which 115 name a technology.[8,9]

4. Partnership priorities and why

The Partnership Strength Index scores how strong a partner is in energy supply chains: as a reliable supplier (Friendshore), as an export market (Partnership Opportunity) or, for middle- and lower-income partners, through Development Potential. From Austria's viewpoint it rates Germany highest, as an export market,

strongest in upstream electric vehicles, upstream batteries, upstream wind, midstream electric grid and midstream wind.[1]

The United States ranks 2nd, as a reliable supplier; Italy ranks 3rd, as an export market; Poland ranks 4th and Hungary 5th, each as a reliable supplier.[1]

Today's ties largely match this ranking. By average share across its energy-goods baskets, Germany is Austria's 1st trade partner, the United States its 2nd, Italy its 4th, Hungary its 5th and Poland its 6th. The index calls each of them a priority partner with strong ties today.[1,4]

The exceptions are large trade partners it ranks lower. China is Austria's 3rd trade partner but ranks 43rd on Partnership Strength, as a development partner, and Austria and China vote in opposite blocs at the United Nations. Switzerland, its 7th trade partner, ranks 44th.[1,4,10]

As a partner to the coalition, Austria ranks 11th of 192 economies, averaged over the core members' viewpoints. In the allied network design, which spreads upstream and midstream production across coalition members, Austria's derived shares are largest in midstream gas (0.7%) and midstream green hydrogen (0.6%).[1,7]

5. Data notes and caveats

Values are as of 12 October 2026. Scores compare Austria with other economies in the same sector; they are not measures of risk or profit in absolute terms. All index values are the paper's baseline as of 12 October 2026; Strategic Insights recomputes them under other weightings. Some figures behind these scores are filled in where the source has no value: with zero where a source lists every holder, otherwise with the world average. Strategic Index scores within 0.01 of each other are almost tied: small changes in the data or the weights can swap their order. In the allied network design the European Union is one producer; Austria's shares are derived from its weight within the EU. The Climate Action Tracker rates the EU as a whole; Austria carries the EU's rating. Trade figures count trade with other EU members. Many allied picks are close calls: in the paper, 37% of them are within 0.01 of the runner-up. Austria's counts leave out the EU's own 438 International Energy Agency policy records. Country Insights shows the detail.

Sources

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Allied Industrial Base Explorer, Country Insights: Austria